

ZARIKS(TM) SCHOOL FOOD & NUTRITION INITIATIVE

FOOD SMART CLUB(TM) IMPLEMENTATION PACK

JSS EDITION

INVESTIGATE - MEASURE - ANALYZE - REPORT - LEAD

Purpose

A structured co-curricular system that turns food literacy into student participation, leadership, garden observation, practical challenges and school-wide learning. It works with or without a GrowMeal(TM) Garden.

GrowMeal(TM) connection

Where a LIFEWS AgriShine(TM) GrowMeal(TM) Garden exists, it becomes the club's living laboratory. Schools without a garden can use approved specimens, flashcards, classroom charts, journals and Ingredient Lab activities.

1. CLUB SETUP & PATRON GUIDE

Recommended format

Students take defined club offices and project roles. Activities can include controlled comparisons, garden records, package literacy and evidence-based school improvement proposals.

Teacher/Patron responsibility

Approve activities, supervise practical work and garden access, protect safeguarding and food-safety boundaries, verify student records, prevent unsupported health claims, and ensure participation/recognition never depends on product purchases.

Suggested meeting rhythm

One structured club meeting each week or every two weeks. A standard meeting can use: Welcome -> Review -> Challenge -> Record -> Share -> Next action.

Evidence

Data tables, practical rubrics, reports, challenge evidence, peer presentations and teacher assessment.

2. CLUB CONSTITUTION & RULES

1. The club exists to improve food, ingredient, garden, water, hygiene and food-system literacy.
2. Membership is voluntary and inclusive according to school policy.
3. The teacher/patron has final responsibility for safety and activity approval.
4. Club activities are educational; purchasing ZARIKS(TM) products is never a condition of membership, badges or certificates.
5. Members record actual observations and do not invent measurements or results.
6. No tasting is required. Food-contact activities follow school allergy, hygiene and safeguarding procedures.
7. Garden tools and laboratory materials are used only under appropriate supervision.
8. Members treat one another respectfully and share leadership opportunities.
9. The club may use GrowMeal(TM) as a learning laboratory but should not interfere with garden operations.
10. Public-facing claims, posters and presentations should be accurate, age-appropriate and teacher-reviewed.

3. STUDENT LEADERSHIP & PROJECT ROLES

Role	Responsibility
President / Student Lead	Coordinates meetings, keeps activities educational and works with the teacher patron.
Vice President / Deputy Lead	Supports coordination and leads when the student lead is absent.
Secretary / Records Lead	Maintains attendance, minutes, challenge records and action points.
Ingredient Explorer	Leads ingredient identification and observation activities.
Plant-Part Detective	Supports accurate botanical classification.
Garden Observer	Connects club activities to GrowMeal(TM) and records visible crop changes.
Water Smart Champion	Promotes responsible water-use learning.
Food Safety Champion	Reinforces hygiene, clean tools and safe handling.
Farm-to-Food Reporter	Documents production-to-consumption pathways.
Food Smart Communicator	Coordinates noticeboard, presentations and showcase materials.

Leadership appointment record

Role	Student	Term / Date	Teacher approval
President / Student Lead			
Vice President / Deputy Lead			
Secretary / Records Lead			
Ingredient Explorer			
Plant-Part Detective			
Garden Observer			
Water Smart Champion			
Food Safety Champion			
Farm-to-Food Reporter			
Food Smart Communicator			

4. MEMBER REGISTER & ATTENDANCE

No.	Student name	Class	Joined	Passport issued
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17				
18				
19				
20				

ATTENDANCE RECORD

No.	Student	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						

5. 12-WEEK CLUB CALENDAR

Week	Challenge	Core activity	Garden connection
1	Ingredient Hunt	Find or identify approved ingredients in the classroom, garden or resource cards; record name, plant part and one observation.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
2	Plant-Part Detective	Classify flower/calyx, fruit, leaf, seed, rhizome, stem and root examples; use GrowMeal(TM) plants where available.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
3	GrowMeal Crop Watch	Observe one garden crop over time; record age-appropriate changes without inventing results.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
4	Water Smart Mission	Observe how water is used in the garden/school and propose one practical responsible-use improvement.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
5	Farm-to-Food Race	Arrange production-to-consumption stages for one crop and explain why some foods need different processing routes.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
6	Food Safe Mission	Identify good hygiene and handling practices from garden harvest to classroom investigation.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
7	Package Detective	Examine verified package information: product name, ingredient list, storage/date information and claims appropriate to age.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
8	Local Food Explorer	Document a locally familiar crop/food, its plant part, how it is used and its farm-to-food pathway.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
9	Food Waste Challenge	Observe avoidable food/garden waste and propose an age-appropriate reduction, reuse or compost-learning action.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
10	Ingredient Scientist	Conduct a teacher-approved observation or investigation using the Ingredient Lab Workbook.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
11	Food Story Challenge	Communicate one ingredient journey through a drawing, sequence, poster, report or short presentation.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.
12	Food Smart Showcase	Prepare a final station demonstrating what the club learned across garden, ingredient, food, water and safety themes.	Use GrowMeal(TM) crop/area where available; classroom alternative permitted.

CHALLENGE 1: INGREDIENT HUNT

Mission

Find or identify approved ingredients in the classroom, garden or resource cards; record name, plant part and one observation.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 2: PLANT-PART DETECTIVE

Mission

Classify flower/calyx, fruit, leaf, seed, rhizome, stem and root examples; use GrowMeal(TM) plants where available.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 3: GROWMEAL CROP WATCH

Mission

Observe one garden crop over time; record age-appropriate changes without inventing results.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 4: WATER SMART MISSION

Mission

Observe how water is used in the garden/school and propose one practical responsible-use improvement.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 5: FARM-TO-FOOD RACE

Mission

Arrange production-to-consumption stages for one crop and explain why some foods need different processing routes.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 6: FOOD SAFE MISSION

Mission

Identify good hygiene and handling practices from garden harvest to classroom investigation.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 7: PACKAGE DETECTIVE

Mission

Examine verified package information: product name, ingredient list, storage/date information and claims appropriate to age.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 8: LOCAL FOOD EXPLORER

Mission

Document a locally familiar crop/food, its plant part, how it is used and its farm-to-food pathway.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 9: FOOD WASTE CHALLENGE

Mission

Observe avoidable food/garden waste and propose an age-appropriate reduction, reuse or compost-learning action.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 10: INGREDIENT SCIENTIST

Mission

Conduct a teacher-approved observation or investigation using the Ingredient Lab Workbook.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 11: FOOD STORY CHALLENGE

Mission

Communicate one ingredient journey through a drawing, sequence, poster, report or short presentation.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

CHALLENGE 12: FOOD SMART SHOWCASE

Mission

Prepare a final station demonstrating what the club learned across garden, ingredient, food, water and safety themes.

Connected resources

Use the relevant combination of Ingredient Flashcards, Observation Journal + Food Smart Passport(TM), Ingredient Lab Workbook, Plant-Part Matching Cards, Farm-to-Food Sequence Cards, classroom charts and Teacher Assessment Pack.

GrowMeal(TM) option

Use a real garden crop, garden record or supervised observation where the activity and crop stage are suitable. If unavailable, use approved classroom specimens/images.

My / our evidence

Teacher / Patron check: _____ Date: _____

6. FOOD SMART MISSION CARDS

FIND IT

Find one approved ingredient or crop and name it.

CLASSIFY IT

Identify the plant part correctly.

WATCH IT

Record one visible change in a GrowMeal(TM) crop or approved specimen.

MEASURE IT

Count or measure one appropriate feature.

FOLLOW IT

Put its farm-to-food stages in order.

PROTECT IT

Identify one hygiene or handling action.

TRACE THE WATER

Explain where water enters the crop/food pathway.

TRACE THE ENERGY

Identify one place energy is used in growing, preparation, processing or storage.

READ IT

Find one verified piece of information on an approved food package.

EXPLAIN IT

Teach another student one accurate thing you learned.

IMPROVE IT

Suggest one practical improvement for the garden or school food-learning environment.

SHARE IT

Prepare one exhibit for the Food Smart Showcase.

7. SCHOOL FOOD SMART LEARNING AUDIT

Important boundary

This is a student learning exercise, not a regulatory inspection or professional food-safety audit. Students observe educational opportunities and propose improvements for teacher/school review.

Learning area	Student observation question
Garden learning	Can students identify what is growing? Is there a place to record observations?
Water learning	Can students explain how water is used and where waste might be reduced?
Hand hygiene learning	Are appropriate hand-cleaning routines taught before relevant activities?
Food protection learning	Can students identify why harvested/learning specimens should be protected from contamination?
Food waste learning	Are there opportunities to discuss avoidable waste, reuse or compost learning?
Package literacy	Are students taught to read verified package information rather than judge only by advertising?
Noticeboard learning	Does the school display current food/garden learning rather than commercial slogans?
Student participation	Do students have opportunities to investigate, record and present what they learn?

Three improvements we propose

1.
2.
3.

8. FOOD SMART NOTICEBOARD KIT

INGREDIENT OF THE MONTH

Name, plant part, garden/source image and one verified observation.

FOOD QUESTION OF THE WEEK

A short question students can investigate or discuss.

GROWMEAL(TM) UPDATE

What is planted, what changed, what students observed.

FOOD SMART FACT

One teacher-reviewed food, water, ingredient or safety fact.

CURRENT CHALLENGE

The active club mission and completion date.

STUDENT EVIDENCE

Selected drawings, tables, photos or reports approved by the school.

UPCOMING SHOWCASE

Date, theme and student preparation tasks.

9. POINTS, BADGES & ACHIEVEMENT

Badge	Evidence
Ingredient Explorer	Recognizes and records ingredients.
Plant-Part Detective	Correctly classifies plant structures.
GrowMeal Observer	Maintains garden/crop observations.
Water Smart Champion	Demonstrates responsible water-use learning.
Farm-to-Food Explorer	Explains production-to-consumption pathways.
Food Safety Champion	Demonstrates hygiene and handling concepts.
Ingredient Investigator	Completes age-appropriate practical investigation.
Food Smart Communicator	Shares accurate learning with others.
Food Smart Ambassador	Shows sustained participation, responsible leadership and completed evidence.

Points rule

Schools may use a simple points system for participation, evidence, teamwork and communication. Points must reward learning and service - never purchases, sales or consumption of branded products.

10. FOOD SMART PASSPORT(TM) - CLUB EXTENSION

Challenge	Completed	Teacher initial	Evidence page / note
Ingredient Hunt			
Plant-Part Detective			
GrowMeal Crop Watch			
Water Smart Mission			
Farm-to-Food Race			
Food Safe Mission			
Package Detective			
Local Food Explorer			
Food Waste Challenge			
Ingredient Scientist			
Food Story Challenge			
Food Smart Showcase			

GrowMeal(TM) achievements

Achievement	Date	Teacher initial
I planted / established it		
I observed it		
I measured it		
I used water responsibly		
I identified the plant part		
I harvested it safely		
I investigated it		
I followed its farm-to-food journey		
I shared what I learned		

11. SCHOOL NUTRITION DAY PLANNER

Station	Plan / lead / materials
DISCOVER station	Crops / ingredients / plant parts _____
GROW station	Planting, crop care or monitoring _____
WATER station	Responsible water use _____
HARVEST station	Supervised harvest/handling where appropriate _____
INVESTIGATE station	Ingredient Lab demonstration _____
FOLLOW THE FOOD station	Farm-to-Food sequencing _____
READ station	Age-appropriate package literacy _____
SHARE station	Student journals, posters and presentations _____

Event principle

The day is a learning experience, not a sales fair. Student recognition is tied to participation and evidence.

12. TERM SHOWCASE & COMPETITION TOOLKIT

Criterion	What judges look for	Points
Accuracy	Information and classifications are correct and teacher-reviewed.	25
Evidence	The team shows observations, records, measurements or completed activities.	25
Explanation	Students can explain the crop/ingredient/food pathway clearly.	20
Application	The exhibit connects learning to garden, water, safety, food or school practice.	15
Communication & teamwork	Presentation is organized, understandable and shared across the team.	15

Competition categories

- Best Ingredient Investigation
- Best GrowMeal(TM) Crop Story
- Best Plant-Part Classification Team
- Best Water Smart Idea
- Best Farm-to-Food Explanation
- Best Food Smart Noticeboard
- Best Student Communicator
- Best Team Learning Exhibit

13. TEACHER MONITORING & CLUB IMPACT RECORD

Indicator	Term evidence / note
Participation	Number/consistency of students participating. _____
Resource use	Which ZARIKS(TM) learning resources were used. _____
GrowMeal(TM) use	Garden sessions/crops connected to club activities. _____
Student evidence	Journals, passport stamps, challenge sheets, reports or presentations. _____
Knowledge progression	Observed improvement in naming, classification, sequencing, investigation or communication. _____
Leadership	Student roles carried out responsibly. _____
Safety	Any issues, adaptations or lessons for future activities. _____
School engagement	Noticeboard, Nutrition Day, showcase, teacher/parent/stakeholder participation. _____

Next-term priorities

1.	
2.	
3.	

14. FOUNDING 200 CLUB RECOGNITION

School recognition language

This school is recognized as a participating ZARIKS(TM) Food Smart Club(TM) school within the ZARIKS(TM) School Food & Nutrition Initiative, supported by LIFEWS Foundation. Recognition reflects participation in educational activities and does not constitute professional accreditation.

School: _____

Club Patron: _____

Term / Year: _____

Club evidence completed: ☐ Challenges ☐ Passport ☐ GrowMeal(TM) activities ☐ Showcase

15. CERTIFICATES & RECOGNITION LANGUAGE

FOOD SMART CLUB MEMBER

For participating in Food Smart Club(TM) learning activities. Teacher/Patron: _____ Date: _____

ACTIVE FOOD SMART MEMBER

For sustained participation and completed challenge evidence. Teacher/Patron: _____ Date: _____

FOOD SMART CLUB LEADER

For responsible student leadership and service. Teacher/Patron: _____ Date: _____

FOOD SMART CHALLENGE CHAMPION

For strong performance in a designated learning challenge. Teacher/Patron: _____ Date: _____

FOOD SMART AMBASSADOR

For sustained learning, leadership, accurate communication and completed portfolio/passport evidence. Teacher/Patron: _____ Date: _____

Credential boundary

These recognitions document school programme participation and learning. They are not regulated nutrition, food-science, food-safety or professional credentials.